

Staff Memo

The Hackles Kit

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · quillsup.org · October 2026

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A one-page memo for teachers, librarians, aides and volunteers who will deliver or support Hackles lessons. Fill the brackets, have your administrator approve it, and send it before the staff session.

FIELD NOTE	No. 1
To: [Teachers, librarians, aides, volunteers]	
From: [Principal / Director / Hackles lead]	
Date: [date]	
Subject: Hackles online-safety lessons starting [date]	

What is happening

Starting [date], [grades or groups] will use Hackles, a free kit of ten 15-minute lessons per grade band. Each lesson has a hook (2 minutes), an activity (8), a discussion (3) and a takeaway with an exit ticket (2). The kit comes as printed pages, slides and a teacher guide for your band. The habit we teach is *Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell.*

Our lead is [name, contact]. Our counselor is [name, contact]. The first lesson in your class is [date and period].

What you need to do

1. **Attend the staff session** on [date, time]. It includes practice responding to a disclosure. ([60 to 90] minutes.)
2. **Read your band's teacher guide** and the one-page First 10 Minutes card. Put the card and our local Help Map in your lesson binder.
3. **Know our reporting route** (below).
4. **Teach on the schedule.** Sensitive lessons are marked on the calendar. Do not move them without telling [counselor].
5. **Tell the counselor** at least [three weeks] before a sensitive lesson, using the heads-up message in the Counselor Toolkit.
6. **Send family letters** on the dates on the calendar. The administrator approves the text first.
7. **Record counts only** in the tracker: lessons delivered, Help-Ladder practice, opt-outs, reply slips, survey tallies. Never a name or ID.

What to expect

- Some students will tell you something real. That is the lessons working. You are not an investigator. You listen, reassure, report and hand off.
- Some students will have strong reactions. Allow breaks. The counselor is on call for sensitive lessons.
- Some families will ask questions or opt out. Be warm. Offer the preview and the alternate activity. Never pressure or ask a child to explain.
- The kit is a pilot-stage resource. Tell [Hackles lead] about any error, wrong number or broken link, and about lessons that did not work.

If a student tells you something serious

1. Stay calm. Say: "Thank you for telling me. This is not your fault. You are not in trouble."
2. Move somewhere private but visible to other adults.
3. Listen. Ask only "Tell me more" and "What happened next?" Do not ask leading questions.
4. Do not promise secrecy. Say you need to get them help and you will tell them who you tell.
5. **Never view, copy, forward or screenshot** a suspected intimate image of a minor. Secure the device only as our policy directs.
6. **Report personally**, as the law and our policy require: [local fill: reporting line, phone number, deadline, backup contact]. Then tell [administrator] and [counselor].

- 7. Write the child's exact words on the confidential form the same day.
- 8. Care for yourself. Debrief with the counselor.

SEE THE CRISIS AND Disclosure Flowchart. Keep it where you can find it.

What not to do

- Do not teach a sensitive lesson without the counselor heads-up and the family notice.
- Do not ask students to share personal experiences or show content.
- Do not use the Plus lessons on trafficking or mental health until we have confirmed that the specialist or clinician review is done. [local fill]
- Do not collect student names or work samples for the tracker, and do not photograph students without our photo-consent process.
- Do not tell families the program will protect their child or has been approved.

Calendar

DATE	ITEM
[date]	Staff session
[date]	Family letter 1 sent
[date]	Pre survey (if used)
[date]	Lesson 1
[dates]	Sensitive lessons and their notice dates
[date]	Counts due to the tracker
[date]	Post survey (if used)
[date]	Hackles Day or showcase

THANK YOU. THIS IS a lot of care for children, and it counts.